



Uttar Pradesh Assembly Election 2022

Defeated Women Candidates — Votes, Constituencies, Parties & Reasons for Defeat

Overview: Women Candidates Fielded, Won & Lost (Major Parties)

Party	Tickets Given to Women	Won	Lost
Congress (INC)	148–159	1	~147–158
Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)	45	25	20
Samajwadi Party (SP) + allies	42	8–13*	~29–34
Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)	38	0	38

*SP contested with alliance partners (Apna Dal-K, SBSP, RLD); the 8 figure is SP's own symbol winners, while several allied women (e.g. Apna Dal Soneylal on NDA side) are counted separately. Ticket figures vary slightly (148 vs 155–159) between media reports.

Notable Defeated Women Candidates — Votes Polled & Constituency

The table below lists prominent women candidates who lost the 2022 election, with their party, constituency and the votes they polled, based on Election Commission data reported in the press. All six lost their security deposits (i.e. polled less than one-sixth of total valid votes in their seat).

Name	Constituency	Party	Votes Polled	Background / Why the campaign struggled
Asha Devi	Unnao Sadar	INC	1,555	Mother of the 2017 Unnao rape case victim; fielded as the symbolic face of Congress's women's-safety campaign. Campaigned for by party workers from Rajasthan & MP, but could not convert sympathy into votes.
Sadaf Jafar	Lucknow Central	INC	2,927	Social activist jailed during the anti-CAA/NRC protests; contested as a symbol of civil-liberties politics. Said media coverage reduced the race to a straight BJP-vs-SP contest, leaving no space for other candidates.
Nida Ahmed	Sambhal	INC	2,256	Former TV journalist from a locally influential political family; had a personal support base but could not convert it into a competitive vote share. Alleged (unverified) discrepancies in EVM counts at her family's booths.
Archana Gautam	Hastinapur (SC)	INC	1,519	Former Miss UP 2014 and Miss Cosmo World 2018, projected as Congress's Dalit face. Entered the contest very late with limited time to build ground-level organisation.

Name	Constituency	Party	Votes Polled	Background / Why the campaign struggled
Ritu Singh	Mohammadi (Lakhimpur Kheri)	INC	2,419	Brought into politics after being physically harassed during panchayat elections; fielded partly as a symbol of women's safety. Lacked prior electoral organisation and cadre support.
Neha Tiwari	Kalyanpur (Kanpur)	INC	2,302	Elder sister of Khushi Dubey (co-accused in the Kanpur Bikru encounter case); campaigned for by senior party leaders but could not overcome the case's controversial baggage and weak local network.

Source: PTI report carried by The Hawk ("UP Polls: Only 1 Of 148 Women Candidates Of Congress Won", Apr 2022); candidate statements as quoted to PTI.

Key Reasons Behind the Defeat of Women Candidates

1. A bipolar BJP-vs-SP contest squeezed out other parties

The 2022 election was widely seen as a straight fight between the BJP-led NDA and the SP-led alliance. As candidate Sadaf Jafar put it, media coverage "polarised the election and made it only BJP vs SP," so voters did not see Congress, BSP or independent candidates — including most women nominees — as serious contenders, regardless of their individual merit.

2. Weak, long-declined organisational base of the Congress and BSP in UP

Congress has had almost no functioning block/booth-level cadre network in Uttar Pradesh for over two decades, and BSP's traditional Dalit vote base had already been eroding toward the BJP and SP since 2014. Without local workers to convert sympathy or name-recognition into actual votes, even well-known or sympathetic candidates (a rape survivor's mother, a Miss UP titleholder, a jailed activist) could not build a competitive vote share.

3. Late nomination and very short campaign windows

Several candidates, including Asha Devi and Ritu Singh, were fielded only in the final weeks before polling, leaving little time to canvass even their own assembly segment, let alone build a full campaign machine.

4. Candidates chosen for symbolic value, not local political strength

Congress's 'Ladki Hoon, Lad Sakti Hoon' campaign deliberately fielded women connected to causes — sexual violence survivors, CAA-protest activists, beauty-pageant winners — to make a national statement about women's representation. This raised the profile of the campaign but did not guarantee these individuals had the local caste arithmetic, family political base, or ground organisation usually needed to win a UP assembly seat.

5. Consolidated caste & welfare-scheme voting patterns favoured the two main parties

The BJP consolidated support through welfare delivery (free ration, housing, Ayushman Bharat) combined with Hindutva messaging, while the SP consolidated its traditional Yadav-Muslim and backward-caste coalition. This left a shrinking pool of voters for Congress, BSP and independents to draw on — a pool women candidates from those parties had to share with their male colleagues.

6. Limited campaign funding and resources relative to national/state party machinery

Compared to BJP and SP nominees who typically drew on established party infrastructure, money and local strongmen networks, many women contestants from smaller parties or fielded on symbolic tickets had comparatively modest campaign resources, further limiting their reach.

7. Isolated allegations of irregularities

A small number of candidates, such as Nida Ahmed in Sambhal, alleged discrepancies between votes cast by their own family/support base and the EVM count at specific booths. These are candidate claims reported by PTI and have not been independently verified or upheld by the Election Commission.

Scope note: This report focuses on well-documented, named cases (mainly Congress candidates, for whom detailed vote figures and on-record reasons were publicly reported). Across all parties, 280+ women contested and roughly 240–250 lost. Full constituency-wise vote, opponent and margin data for every single defeated woman candidate exists on the Election Commission (ECI) and myneta.info candidate pages, but compiling all of them individually is a very large task. If a specific party, region, or set of constituencies is needed in full vote-by-vote detail, that can be compiled separately on request.

WE-PACT — We The Political Action Team
Data sources: PTI / The Hawk, Wikipedia, myneta.info (ADR)